

DRAGON TREE

Dracaena marginata

This is a beautiful small indoor tree that matches its looks with its strength to survive and ability to remove health-sapping toxins. I have always enjoyed the subtle variegation of the foliage, whose spiky tufts give the plant a pleasant palmlike structure.

“My bold presence will take you to the tropics.”

Help me thrive



POSITION

A bright location with indirect sunlight is best for this plant, since direct light will damage its leaves.



POTTING

Repot every other spring into a new container that is slightly bigger than the original. Use an all-purpose potting mix.



GROWTH RATE

These are slow growers, taking about 10 years to grow to full size. When they do, they can reach up to 10ft (3m) tall.



CARE

When in growth, water to keep the soil moist and give a monthly half-strength, slow-release feed. Water much less in winter, letting the soil dry out.



I will boost your mood

My palmlike appearance will transport you somewhere exotic, making you feel cheered and relaxed. My foliage arches and hangs over with age, making me look more like a weeping willow than a palm and adding soothing shape and structure to your room.



Get to know me

The gumlike sap that comes out of my stems is red like dragon's blood, hence my name. In medieval times, this gum was used in alchemy and the magical arts, but today it has a more practical use as a varnish for fine wood.